



READINESS CHECKLIST · FOR LEADERS AND BOARDS

The AI *Readiness* Checklist

A ten-minute read on where your organisation actually stands on AI, across five dimensions, before you invest further.

Tick what is **genuinely in place today**, not what you hope is. The dimension with the fewest ticks is the one to address before more tools or budget.

1 Direction: *what AI is for*

- ☐ We can say, in a sentence, what AI is for here.
- ☐ We have named where AI is, and is not, welcome.
- ☐ AI sits in a plan, not a string of one-off experiments.

2 Ownership: *who is responsible*

- ☐ One named person owns AI direction.
- ☐ Each AI pilot has an owner accountable for the outcome.
- ☐ It is clear who answers when AI-assisted work goes wrong.

3 Data handling: *what is safe to use*

- ☐ People know what must never go into a public AI tool.
- ☐ We know where staff and client data are allowed to go.
- ☐ Sensitive work has a sanctioned route, not a workaround.

4 Guardrails: *the rules in practice*

- ☐ We have a short AI policy people have actually read.
- ☐ We know which AI-assisted decisions need human sign-off.
- ☐ Approved tools are named; the rest are off by default.

5 Capability: *whether people can use it well*

- ☐ Our people have had real help, not just access.
- ☐ Good, safe uses get shared, not kept to a few.
- ☐ Leaders use AI on their own work, not just sponsor it.

The gaps are the point, not the ticks. Your thinnest dimension is usually where staff are stuck and budget leaks, and it is almost always a leadership fix before a tooling one.

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